

- encryption (WEP) or Wi-Fi protected access (WPA), which help protect your wireless network. For most routers, you will provide a passphrase that your router uses to generate several keys. Make sure your passphrase is unique and long.
- Your administrative password, which controls your wireless network. Just like any other password, it should not be a word that you can find in the dictionary, and it should be a combination of letters, numbers, and symbols. Be sure you can remember this password, because you'll need it if you ever have to change your router's settings.

The exact steps you follow to configure these settings will vary depending on the

The screenshot shows the web interface of a 'Wireless-G Broadband Router'. At the top, there are three tabs: 'Setup', 'Wireless', and 'Security'. Below these, there are three sub-tabs: 'Management', 'Log', and 'Diagnostics'. The 'Management' sub-tab is selected. In the center, there are two text input fields. The first is labeled 'Router Password:' and the second is labeled 'Re-enter to confirm:'. Both fields contain a series of dots, indicating that the password is masked. At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: 'Save Settings' and 'Cancel Changes'.

Setting an administrative password

type of router you have. After each configuration setting, be sure to click Save Settings, Apply, or OK to save your changes.

Now, you should disconnect the network cable from your computer.

Connect your computers

If your computer does not have wireless network support built in, plug your network adapter into your USB port in the case of a PC, or insert the network adapter into an empty PC card slot, in the case of a laptop. Windows XP will automatically detect the new adapter, and may prompt you to insert the CD that came with it. Usually, there is native support for several of these. But in the rare case that there isn't, ensure that the CD that came along is at hand. The on-screen instructions will guide you through the configuration process. Clicking next and agreeing to the terms and conditions, if any, should do the trick.

Windows XP should show an icon on the taskbar with a notification that says it has found a wireless network. In case it cannot detect any wireless network, it will let you know this.